

Calling inside Zoho CRM *step by step*

How to give your team a phone inside Zoho CRM: calls from any lead, incoming calls that pop up the caller, dispositions and recordings, all logged in Zoho. Written so that anyone can follow it.

Two ways to do it. Follow the numbered steps in Part III yourself, or let an AI assistant (Claude Cowork, Claude Code or Codex) do it: it first asks you for each key, one after the other, then does every step it can on its own, and shows you where to click (or clicks for you, when it can use your browser) for the steps that happen in the Zoho or Exotel website (Appendix A).

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FOR

Zoho CRM administrators. No technical background needed

TIME NEEDED

About one to two hours, once

VERSION

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Contents

PART I • BEFORE YOU START

- 1 What you are setting up
- 2 What you need
- 3 Keeping keys and passwords safe
- 4 Three basics: the settings file, the terminal, Zoho Setup

PART II • YOUR CREDENTIALS

- 5 Every key, token and secret, and where it goes
- 6 Where they end up inside Zoho

PART III • SETUP, ONE STEP AT A TIME

- 7 Step 0: prepare the computer
- 8 Step 1: Exotel credentials
- 9 Step 2: connect to your Zoho CRM
- 10 Step 3: build the files Zoho needs
- 11 Step 4: the cti_crm connection
- 12 Step 5: the three functions
- 13 Step 6: the four widgets
- 14 Step 7: Call buttons and tabs
- 15 Step 8: the docked phone
- 16 Step 9: incoming calls in Exotel
- 17 Step 10: phone notifications (optional)
- 18 Step 11: turn your team on
- 19 Step 12: test

PART IV • EVERYDAY USE

- 20 For RMs: the phone panel
- 21 For admins: the CTI Admin tab

PART V • WHEN SOMETHING IS OFF

- 22 Messages and what to do

APPENDIX

- A Setting it up with Claude Code or Codex

Before you start

What you will end up with, what to have ready, and three basics used throughout.

1 What you are setting up

A phone inside Zoho CRM, run by Exotel. Your relationship managers (RMs) call and take calls without leaving Zoho, and every call lands in Zoho by itself.

Who	What they get
RMs	A small phone bar docked at the bottom right of Leads, Contacts, Accounts and Deals pages. It opens by itself when a call comes in, showing who is calling.
RMs	A Call button on every lead and contact, and a Call history button with recordings that play right there.
RMs	One switch, Desktop / Phone , for the device they are working on. Desktop: calls in and out run in the browser (SIP). Phone: calls out still use SIP, and calls in ring their mobile as a normal call. A Settings gear lets calls out use their mobile number instead of SIP.
Everyone	Each call logged in Zoho Calls with its outcome (disposition), notes and the recording attached.
Admins	A CTI Admin tab: switch calling on for a person, add their number, and their calling line is created automatically.
Callers	Incoming calls go to the owner of the lead calling in, or to the next free RM. A caller who isn't in Zoho becomes a new lead of the RM it rings, so their phone shows who is calling.

2 What you need

- ☐ **Zoho CRM admin login.** Your Zoho edition must show *Developer Hub* with Functions, Widgets, Connections and Client Script in Setup. If one is missing, ask Zoho to enable it.
- ☐ **An Exotel account with WebRTC (browser calling) enabled**, KYC complete and some balance.
- ☐ **At least one Exotel virtual number (ExoPhone).** Customers see it when you call, and dial it to reach you.
- ☐ **Your Exotel Client ID and Client Secret.** Your Exotel account manager sends these when WebRTC is enabled.
- ☐ **A Windows or Mac computer** with Google Chrome, for about an hour.
- ☐ **The project folder** you received with this guide, unzipped somewhere easy to find, such as the Desktop.
- ☐ **Each RM's mobile number**, for Step 11.

3 Keeping keys and passwords safe

TREAT EVERY CREDENTIAL LIKE A BANK PASSWORD

Anyone with your Exotel API key and token can make calls billed to your account. Type them only into the settings file (section 4) or into the Zoho and Exotel screens this guide names. Do not email them, paste them into chats, or take screenshots that show them. The two web addresses you copy in Step 5 (they contain `zapikey`) are secret too.

4 Three basics used throughout

The settings file (.env)

Your keys go into one small text file in the project folder called `.env`. In Step 0 you make it by copying `.env.example`.

- 1 Open it with Notepad (Windows: right-click > Open with > Notepad) or TextEdit (Mac). On a Mac the file is hidden: in the folder press **Cmd + Shift + .** to show it.
- 2 Each line looks like `EXOTEL_API_KEY=`. Type the value straight after the `=`, with no spaces and no quotes:
`EXOTEL_API_KEY=a1b2c3...`
- 3 Save the file. Never rename it.

The terminal

A few steps need you to type a short command. Open a terminal **in the project folder**:

- **Windows:** open the project folder, click the address bar at the top, type `cmd`, press Enter.
- **Mac:** right-click the project folder > Services > New Terminal at Folder.

Type the command exactly as printed in this guide and press Enter. Wait until it finishes. Green ticks mean good; a red cross or the word *Error* means read the message, fix what it says, and run the same command again. Running a command twice is always safe.

Zoho Setup

In Zoho CRM click the gear icon (Setup) at the top right. Setup has a search box at the top: typing a name such as *Functions* or *Client Script* is the quickest way to every screen named in this guide.

Your credentials

Every key, token and secret this setup uses: what it looks like, where you find it, and where you put it.

5 Every key, token and secret, and where it goes

Collect them in this order. You type the ones marked **You** into `.env`; the ones marked **Automatic** are written there for you by a command.

#	Credential	Looks like	Where you find it	Goes into .env as
1	Account SID	a short name, e.g. yourcompany1m	Exotel dashboard, <i>API Credentials</i> at the top (also Settings > API Settings)	EXOTEL_ACCOUNT_SID (You)
2	API Key	a long mix of letters and digits	Same page	EXOTEL_API_KEY (You)
3	API Token	a long mix of letters and digits	Same page	EXOTEL_API_TOKEN (You)
4	Region address	api.in.exotel.com	India (Mumbai): api.in.exotel.com. Singapore: api.exotel.com	EXOTEL_SUBDOMAIN (You)
5	Client ID (customer credential)	a long id	The document from your Exotel account manager	EXOTEL_CLIENT_ID (You)
6	Client Secret (customer credential)	a long secret	Same document	EXOTEL_CLIENT_SECRET (You)
7	Integration address	https://integrationscore.mum1.exotel.com	India: exactly as shown. Other regions: ask Exotel	EXOTEL_ICORE_BASE (You)
8	App name	Zoho CTI	You choose it	EXOTEL_APP_NAME (You)
9	App ID and App Secret	long ids	Created by <code>npm run provision</code> in Step 1	EXOTEL_APP_ID, EXOTEL_APP_SECRET (Automatic)
10	Zoho Client ID and Client Secret	1000.ABC...	Zoho API Console > Self Client > Client Secret tab (Step 2)	ZOHO_CLIENT_ID, ZOHO_CLIENT_SECRET (You)
11	Zoho one-time code	1000.xyz...	Same Self Client > Generate Code (Step 2). Lasts 10 minutes	Not stored: typed once into a command
12	Zoho refresh token and accounts address	long	Created from the one-time code by <code>npm run zoho:auth</code>	ZOHO_REFRESH_TOKEN, ZOHO_ACCOUNTS_URL (Automatic)
13	cti_webhook and cti_route addresses	https://www.zohoapis...&zapikey=...	Zoho, after Step 5 (each function's REST API > API Key)	Not in .env: the webhook one is given to a command in Step 5; both go into the Exotel flow in Step 9

NOTHING TO TYPE FOR YOUR VIRTUAL NUMBERS

Your ExoPhones (the numbers customers see and dial) are read from your Exotel account. The CTI Admin tab offers them for each person.

LEAVE THESE EMPTY

`EXOTEL_CALLER_ID`, `EXOTEL_WEBRTC_USER_ID`, `EXOTEL_AGENT_NAME` and `EXOTEL_AGENT_NUMBER` stay empty. Each person's calling line is created later from the CTI Admin tab, when you add their number.

6 Where they end up inside Zoho

The command `npm run zoho:cti-setup` copies what Zoho needs from `.env` into Zoho's own settings, called *org variables* (Setup > Developer Hub > Variables). You never type these by hand. If you ever change an Exotel key, put it in `.env` and run that command again.

Zoho variable	Holds	Comes from
<code>exotel_sid</code>	Exotel Account SID	<code>EXOTEL_ACCOUNT_SID</code>
<code>exotel_key</code> , <code>exotel_token</code>	Exotel API key and token	<code>EXOTEL_API_KEY</code> , <code>EXOTEL_API_TOKEN</code>
<code>exotel_subdomain</code> , <code>exotel_ccm</code>	Exotel's addresses for your region	<code>EXOTEL_SUBDOMAIN</code>
<code>exotel_icore</code>	Exotel's integration address	<code>EXOTEL_ICORE_BASE</code>
<code>exotel_app_id</code> , <code>exotel_app_secret</code>	The Exotel app that issues calling lines	<code>EXOTEL_APP_ID</code> , <code>EXOTEL_APP_SECRET</code>
<code>zoho_api_domain</code> , <code>zoho_crm_url</code>	Your Zoho addresses	Read from Zoho
<code>cti_outcome_field</code>	Zoho's call outcome field	Found in Zoho
<code>cti_settings</code>	Dispositions and incoming call rules	Defaults; edited on the CTI Admin tab
<code>cti_webhook_url</code>	Where Exotel reports calls	Step 5 (<code>--webhook</code>)
<code>cti_signal_namespace</code>	Phone notification signal	Step 10 (<code>--signal</code>), optional
<code>cti_app_url</code>	Where the phone screens live	Filled in by the CTI itself

Setup, one step at a time

Do the steps in order. Each ends with what you should see. Tick them off as you go.

7 Step 0: prepare the computer

- 1 Install **Node.js**: go to `nodejs.org`, download the version marked **LTS**, open it and click Next until it finishes.
- 2 Open a terminal in the project folder (section 4) and type `node -v`. You should see `v20` or a higher number.
- 3 Type `npm install` and wait until it finishes (a minute or two).
- 4 In the project folder, copy the file `.env.example` and name the copy `.env`.

You should see: a file called `.env` in the project folder.

8 Step 1: Exotel credentials

- 1 Log in to your Exotel dashboard and click **API Credentials** at the top. Put **Account SID**, **API Key** and **API Token** into `.env` (rows 1 to 3 of section 5).
- 2 Put your region address into `EXOTEL_SUBDOMAIN` (row 4).
- 3 From Exotel's document, put the **Client ID** into `EXOTEL_CLIENT_ID` and the **Client Secret** into `EXOTEL_CLIENT_SECRET`.
- 4 Set `EXOTEL_ICORE_BASE=https://integrationscore.mum1.exotel.com` and `EXOTEL_APP_NAME=Zoho CTI`. Save `.env`.
- 5 In the terminal type `npm run provision`.

You should see: ticks for the application and call recording, and `EXOTEL_APP_ID` and `EXOTEL_APP_SECRET` now filled in inside `.env`. A warning that `EXOTEL_WEBRTC_USER_ID` is empty is expected.

IF IT MENTIONS A TRIAL ACCOUNT

Exotel replied that the account is a trial account, where browser calling users can't be created. Ask your Exotel account manager to make the account live, then run `npm run provision` again.

9 Step 2: connect to your Zoho CRM

This lets the setup commands prepare your Zoho CRM. Use the API Console for the Zoho site you log in to: `api-console.zoho.in` (India), `api-console.zoho.com` (US), `api-console.zoho.eu` (Europe), `api-console.zoho.com.au` (Australia).

- 1 Open the API Console, click **Add Client**, choose **Self Client**, click **Create**.

- 2 Open the **Client Secret** tab. Put the **Client ID** into `ZOHO_CLIENT_ID` and the **Client Secret** into `ZOHO_CLIENT_SECRET`. Save `.env`.
- 3 Open the **Generate Code** tab. In **Scope** paste exactly:
`ZohoCRM.settings.ALL,ZohoCRM.modules.ALL,ZohoCRM.users.READ,ZohoCRM.org.READ`
- 4 Time Duration: **10 minutes**. Description: *CTI setup*. Click **Create**, choose your CRM organisation, and copy the code shown.
- 5 Straight away, in the terminal type `npm run zoho:auth --` followed by the code, for example `npm run zoho:auth -- 1000.abc123...`
- 6 Then type `npm run zoho:cti-setup`.

You should see: ticks for the CTI Agents module, the Calls fields and the org variables, ending with **Done**. In Zoho you now have a module called *CTI Agents*.

IF THE CODE EXPIRED

Codes last 10 minutes. Generate a new one (point 3) and run `npm run zoho:auth -- <new code>` again.

10 Step 3: build the files Zoho needs

- 1 In the terminal type `npm run zoho:widget`.

You should see: a folder called `out` in the project folder with `zoho-cti-widget.zip` (the phone screens) and a folder `zoho-functions` holding `cti_api.txt`, `cti_webhook.txt` and `cti_route.txt` (the server code you paste in Step 5).

11 Step 4: the cti_crm connection

This lets the CTI read and save each person's calling settings for them. It must be created and connected by a Zoho **administrator**: the CTI uses it for everyone, so RMs need no special access, whatever your sharing rules are.

- 1 Zoho Setup > Developer Hub > **Connections** > **Create Connection**.
- 2 Pick the service **Zoho OAuth**.
- 3 Connection Name: `cti_crm`. Check that the Connection Link Name also reads `cti_crm`.
- 4 Scopes: tick or type `ZohoCRM.users.ALL`, `ZohoCRM.modules.ALL`, `ZohoCRM.settings.variables.ALL`, `ZohoCRM.settings.fields.ALL`.
- 5 Click **Create and Connect**, then **Connect**, then **Accept**.

You should see: `cti_crm` in the list, marked Connected.

12 Step 5: the three functions

Do this three times, in this order: `cti_api`, `cti_webhook`, `cti_route`.

- 1 Zoho Setup > Developer Hub > **Functions** > **New Function**.
- 2 Function Name and Display Name: the name exactly, for example `cti_api`. Category: **Standalone**. Click **Create**.
- 3 Open `out/zoho-functions/cti_api.txt` in Notepad or TextEdit, select everything (Ctrl+A or Cmd+A), copy.
- 4 In Zoho's editor, select everything, paste, click **Save**.
- 5 Back in the function list, open the function's menu (three dots) > **REST API**:
 - 6 `cti_api`: **OAuth2** on, **API Key** off. Save.
 - 7 `cti_webhook` and `cti_route`: **API Key** on. Copy the address shown and keep it somewhere safe (it is secret). Save.
- 8 After `cti_webhook`: in the terminal type `npm run zoho:cti-setup -- --webhook "` its address `"`, keeping the quotes.

IF ZOHO WON'T TAKE THE FIRST LINE

Some Zoho editors keep their own first line. Then click **Edit Arguments**, add one argument named `crmAPIRequest` of type **Map**, and paste only what is between the first `{` and the last `}` of the file.

You should see: three functions saved without errors, and the `cti_route` address kept for Step 9.

13 Step 6: the four widgets

Zoho Setup > Developer Hub > **Widgets** > **Create New Widget**. Make these four, each with Hosting **Zoho** and the file `out/zoho-cti-widget.zip`:

Name (exactly)	Type	Index page	Used for
Exotel CTI	Button	<code>/cti.html</code>	The Call button and the docked phone
CTI History	Button	<code>/history.html</code>	The Call history button
CTI Admin	Web Tab	<code>/admin.html</code>	The admin tab
Exotel Phone	Web Tab	<code>/phone.html</code>	A keypad to call any number, also from the Zoho phone app

You should see: four widgets listed. The first one's API name reads `Exotel_CTI`.

UPDATING LATER

When you receive a newer version, run `npm run zoho:widget` again, open each widget, upload the new zip and save.

14 Step 7: Call buttons and tabs

- 1 Zoho Setup > Customization > **Modules and Fields** > **Leads** > **Buttons** > **Create New Button**.
- 2 Name `Call`. Show it on the record's details page. Action: **Widget**, choose **Exotel CTI**. Allow all profiles. Save.
- 3 Create a second button on Leads: name `Call history`, widget **CTI History**.
- 4 Repeat points 1 to 3 for **Contacts**.
- 5 Zoho Setup > Modules and Fields > **Web Tab** > **New Web Tab** (or search *Web Tabs*): name `CTI Admin`, type **Widget**, choose **CTI Admin**, give it to the **Administrator** profile only. Save.
- 6 One more Web Tab: name `Phone`, type **Widget**, choose **Exotel Phone**, **all profiles**. It is a keypad for calling any number, including people who aren't in Zoho, and it also appears in the Zoho phone app.

You should see: Call and Call history on every lead and contact, a Phone tab for everyone, and a CTI Admin tab for admins.

15 Step 8: the docked phone

Eight small scripts put the phone bar at the bottom right of pages. They are in the project folder under `zoho-cti/client-scripts`. For each row: Zoho Setup > Developer Hub > **Client Script** > **New Script**, fill in as shown, click Next, select everything in the editor, paste the whole file, Save.

File	Module	Page	Event
Leads-list-page.js	Leads	List Page (Standard)	Page Event > onCustomViewLoad
Leads-detail-page.js	Leads	Detail Page (Standard)	Page Event > onLoad
Contacts-list-page.js	Contacts	List Page (Standard)	onCustomViewLoad
Contacts-detail-page.js	Contacts	Detail Page (Standard)	onLoad
Accounts-list-page.js	Accounts	List Page (Standard)	onCustomViewLoad
Accounts-detail-page.js	Accounts	Detail Page (Standard)	onLoad
Deals-list-page.js	Deals	List Page (Standard)	onCustomViewLoad
Deals-detail-page.js	Deals	Detail Page (Standard)	onLoad

Name each one like *Exotel phone dock (Leads list)*. The phone bar shows only on computers; in the Zoho phone app people use the Call button.

Canvas views need the scripts too

Zoho can show a module in a **Canvas** view (a Custom List View, Tile View or Table View) instead of the standard list. You can tell from the browser address: it contains `/canvas/`. People who get a Canvas view see **no phone bar** unless the script is added for that view as well.

- 1 See which Canvas views you have: Zoho Setup > Customization > **Canvas** > **List View** tab. Each row reads like *Leads - Tile View*.
- 2 For each such view on Leads, Contacts, Accounts or Deals: Setup > Developer Hub > Client Script > **New Script**.
- 3 Name: e.g. *Exotel dock (Leads tile)* (30 characters at most). Category: Module. Page: **List Page (Canvas)**. Module: the module. Canvas Type: **Custom List View**, **Tile View** or **Table View**. Canvas: the one Zoho offers.
- 4 Type: **Page Event**. Event: **onLoad**. Click Next.
- 5 Paste the module's **list** file (for example `Leads-list-page.js`). Save.
- 6 If Setup > Canvas > **Detail View** lists any Canvas detail pages, do the same with Page **Detail Page (Canvas)**, Event **onLoad**, and the module's **detail** file.

You should see: after Step 11, a thin phone bar at the bottom right of those pages.

16 Step 9: incoming calls in Exotel

This tells Exotel to ask Zoho who should take each call to your virtual number. You need the two addresses from Step 5.

- 1 Exotel dashboard > **App Bazaar** > create a new flow (or open the one on your number).
- 2 Optional: a **Greeting**.
- 3 A **Passthru**: URL = the `cti_webhook` address with `&event=incoming` added at the end. Turn **Async** on.
- 4 A **Connect**: choose **Configure parameters dynamically by providing a URL**. Primary URL = the `cti_route` address. Fallback URL = the `cti_route` address with `&fallback=1` added.
- 5 After Connect, on the branch for an answered call: a **Passthru** with the `cti_webhook` address plus `&event=connected`, then **Hangup**.
- 6 On the branch where nobody answered or nobody was dialled: a **Passthru** with the `cti_webhook` address plus `&event=missed`, then Hangup (or a voicemail).
- 7 Save the flow. Exotel dashboard > **ExoPhones**: set this flow on your virtual number.

You should see: the flow attached to your number. Call recording is switched on by Zoho for every call.

17 Step 10: phone notifications (optional)

When the Zoho CRM app is on an RM's phone, Zoho can push "Name is calling" to it.

- 1 Zoho Setup > Experience Center > **Signals**: add a custom signal for incoming calls (service *Exotel*, signal *Incoming call*). Note the **namespace** Zoho shows for it.
- 2 Look at your Zoho CRM address in the browser: copy the part that starts with `org`, for example `org12345678`.
- 3 In the terminal type `npm run zoho:cti-setup -- --signal namespace --org org part`.

18 Step 11: turn your team on

- 1 Open the **CTI Admin** tab. Everyone in your Zoho CRM is listed, with Calling off.
- 2 Switch **Calling** on for a person. Their row asks for their number.
- 3 Type their mobile number (with country code, e.g. `+919812345678`) and press Enter. Their calling line is created in Exotel at once and the row says **SIP line created. Calling is on.**
- 4 Optionally pick the virtual number customers see (Caller ID), the device they work on (Desktop or Phone) and how their calls go out (SIP or Number). Every change saves by itself.
- 5 Ask the person to **reload** any Leads page in Zoho (press F5). The phone bar appears at the bottom right.

GOOD TO KNOW

Until a person has Calling on **and** a number, they get no calls and no phone bar. Switching Calling off stops both. People added to Zoho later appear here with Calling off. If a row says *Their SIP line wasn't created. Exotel replied: "..."*, the words in quotes are Exotel's own answer; share them with Exotel if they are unclear, then switch Calling off and on to try again.

WHEN EXOTEL ALREADY HAS THAT EMAIL OR NUMBER

The Exotel account is often created with the email (and mobile) of the person who is also the Zoho administrator, and that Exotel user must stay on normal phone calls. Exotel keeps one user per email and one per number, so the CTI leaves that user exactly as it is:

- **Email already in Exotel:** the new SIP line is made as *name+sip@* the same domain (for example `asha+sip@company.com`).
- **Number already in Exotel:** the new line is made with SIP only. Zoho still rings that number for the person when calls go to their phone.

The row says which of these happened. If Exotel refuses for any other reason, the row shows Exotel's exact reply.

19 Step 12: test

- ☐ **Outgoing.** Open a lead and click Call. You see *Agent connecting*, *Agent connected*, *Connecting customer*, *Customer connected*, then the disposition choices when it ends.
- ☐ **Microphone.** The first time, Chrome asks to use the microphone: click Allow. It asks only once.
- ☐ **Incoming.** Call your virtual number from another phone. The phone bar opens with the caller's name and company, and rings. From a number that isn't in Zoho, a new lead is made for the person rung, and their phone gets "*number is calling*".
- ☐ **Logged.** Zoho > Calls shows both calls with their disposition; answered calls have the recording attached.

Everyday use

A page each for RMs and admins. Share section 20 with your team.

20 For RMs: the phone panel

The switch at the top, and Settings

Choice	Calls in	Calls out
Desktop	Ring in the browser (SIP), with the caller on screen	From the browser (SIP)
Phone	Ring your mobile as a normal call	SIP, from the Zoho phone app's Call screen
Settings (gear) > Outgoing calls: Number	No change	Exotel rings your mobile first, then the customer

Making and taking calls

- **Call:** click Call on a lead or contact, or type any number in the keypad (the grid button in the phone bar).
- **Call someone who isn't in Zoho, from the phone:** in the Zoho CRM app open **Phone** (in the menu, with the other modules), type the number, call. If your app doesn't show Phone, open any lead, tap Call, then the keypad.
- **Incoming:** the panel opens with who is calling. **Answer**, or **Decline** to pass the call to the next free colleague. **Open lead** shows their record while the call goes on.
- **A caller who isn't in Zoho:** on the computer the panel shows the number. On the phone, Zoho sends a notification "*number* is calling"; **Open lead** opens the new lead made for them, ready to fill in.
- **During a call:** Mute, Keypad, Hold, End.
- **After a call:** choose the outcome (and a detail, if your admin set them), add a note, Save. It goes into the call in Zoho.
- **History:** the clock button or Call history shows past calls with filters; recordings play right there.
- **Lost connection:** if the internet or power drops mid-call, the panel shows what happened when it comes back and offers **Call back**; a call on your mobile carries on.

21 For admins: the CTI Admin tab

- **People:** Calling on or off, Caller ID, mobile number, Works on (Desktop or Phone), Outgoing calls (SIP or Number), and the SIP line Exotel created. Changes save by themselves.
- **Virtual numbers:** each person's Caller ID is one of your ExoPhones. If a number is removed from Exotel, everyone on it moves to the first number the account still has, by itself: when the CTI Admin tab opens

(the row says so) or at their next call.

- **Dispositions:** the outcomes RMs choose after a call, with an optional second level.
- **Incoming calls:** how long a call rings someone before moving on, whether a lead's call stays with its owner, and whether a caller who isn't in Zoho becomes a new lead (the default) or stays a number.

When something is off

The messages you may see, and what to do. Messages that quote Exotel or Zoho show their exact reply.

22 Messages and what to do

You see	Means	Do this
<i>Calling isn't on for you yet. Ask your admin.</i>	Calling is off for this person, or their number is missing.	Admin: CTI Admin tab, switch Calling on and add the number.
<i>The microphone is blocked. Allow it for Zoho.</i>	Chrome (or the Zoho phone app) was told not to use the microphone.	Computer: click the lock icon left of the Zoho address > Microphone > Allow, then reload. Phone: allow the microphone for the Zoho CRM app in the phone's settings. The first SIP call asks for it before it rings.
<i>SIP offline with a Reconnect button</i>	The browser line dropped.	Click Reconnect. Check the internet connection.
<i>The <code>cti_api</code> function did not answer</i>	<code>cti_api</code> isn't reachable from the screens.	Step 5: <code>cti_api</code> > REST API > OAuth2 on.
<i>Couldn't save that in Zoho ... <code>cti_crm</code></i>	The <code>cti_crm</code> connection is missing or not connected.	Step 4, then Connect.
<i>Their SIP line wasn't created. Exotel replied: "..."</i>	Exotel did not create the line; its exact reply is in quotes.	Read Exotel's reply. Switch Calling off and on to retry; share the reply with Exotel if needed.
<i>... "Resource Conflict, Device already exists"</i>	The person's number is already on another Exotel user.	Normally handled for you (the line is made with SIP only). If you still see it, ask Exotel which user has the number.
<i>... "Email already exists for another account"</i>	The email, and its +sip version, are users in a different Exotel account.	Give the person a different email in Zoho, then switch Calling off and on.
<i>Missing in <code>.env</code>: ... (in the terminal)</i>	A value in <code>.env</code> is empty.	Fill in the named lines (section 5) and run the command again.
A person who is switched on sees no phone bar	Usually one of: their page was open before you switched them on; their number is missing; their view is a Canvas view without the Canvas scripts; the Client Scripts (Step 8) are missing; or the <code>cti_crm</code> connection (Step 4) isn't connected.	Ask them to reload the page. In CTI Admin check Calling is on and the number is there. If their address contains <code>/canvas/</code> , add the Canvas scripts (Step 8). In Setup > Connections, <code>cti_crm</code> must show Connected (made by an administrator).
Incoming calls don't reach anyone	The Exotel flow isn't on the number, or nobody is on.	Step 9 point 7; Step 11.

Setting it up with Claude Cowork, Claude Code or Codex

Let an AI assistant run every step it can, and guide you through the rest one step at a time.

The kit contains instructions written for AI assistants (`zoho-cti/SETUP-PLAYBOOK.md` , found through `CLAUDE.md` and `AGENTS.md`). The assistant follows the same steps as Part III.

Claude Cowork (in the Claude desktop app)

- 1 Install Node.js (Step 0, point 1). Unzip the kit.
- 2 In the Claude desktop app, start a Cowork task and give it the unzipped kit folder.
- 3 Type: **Set up the Exotel CTI in my Zoho CRM.**
- 4 If Claude can use your Chrome (Claude in Chrome), log in to Zoho CRM as an administrator and to the Exotel dashboard when it asks: it then also does the website steps itself.

Claude Code or Codex

- 1 Install Node.js and **Claude Code** or **Codex**, following their own installation pages.
- 2 Open a terminal in the kit folder (section 4) and type `claude` for Claude Code, or `codex` for Codex.
- 3 Type: **Set up the Exotel CTI in my Zoho CRM.**

What happens then (all three)

- 1 It first asks for every key it needs, **one after the other**, in the order of section 5, saying where to find each, and writes each into `.env` itself. It doesn't ask for your virtual numbers: it reads them from Exotel.
- 2 Then it runs every command by itself (provision, Zoho connection, setup, build) and checks the results.
- 3 Two things are asked for only when their step comes: the Zoho one-time code (it lasts 10 minutes) and the two addresses Zoho makes in Step 5.
- 4 For the website steps (connection, functions, widgets, buttons, tabs, Client Scripts, the Exotel flow) it either does them in your browser, or gives you a short list of clicks for that step and waits until you say *done*.
- 5 When everything is finished it tells you, and lists anything skipped.

SECRETS AND ASSISTANTS

The assistant writes your keys only into `.env` on your computer. Paste a key only when it asks for that one key. Don't share screenshots that show keys.

Exotel and Zoho change their screens from time to time. If a menu name differs from this guide, use the search box in Zoho Setup, or the menu in the Exotel dashboard, to find the same screen.